

SHIELD

Strategic Hazard Intervention, Espionage, and Logistics Directorate

SHIELD

FACTFILE

NOTABLE MEMBERS

NICK FURY Former director
CONTESSA VALENTINA ALLEGRA DI FONTAINE
YELENA BELOVA (Black Widow)
G. W. BRIDGE Former director
SHARON CARTER (Agent 13), former director, liaison officer to Captain America
JESSICA DREW (Spider-Woman)
THADDEUS "DUM-DUM" DUGAN former director
MARIA HILL Former director
 Gabriel "Gabe" Jones
AL MACKENZIE CIA liaison officer
ALI MORALES
CLAY QUARTERMAIN
NATASHA ROMANOVA (Black Widow)
JASPER SITWELL
TONY STARK (Iron Man), former director
JIMMY WOO (Agents of Atlas)

BASE

The Helicarrier, mobile

FIRST APPEARANCE

Strange Tales #135 (August 1965)



The longest-serving director of SHIELD, not even Nick Fury knows the identity of the man he replaced.

SHIELD (Supreme Headquarters International Espionage Law-Enforcement Division; later changed to Strategic Hazard Intervention, Espionage and Logistics Directorate) is a counter-terrorism, intelligence, espionage, and peace-keeping organization. SHIELD runs covert as well as military operations, and works with governments and their military forces around the world.

SHIELD'S FORMATION

SHIELD was established to counter the threat posed by the technologically advanced neo-fascist subversive organization known as HYDRA. The identity of SHIELD's founders remained classified, as did the identity of its first executive director, who was

assassinated by HYDRA operatives. SHIELD's second and longest-serving leader was Nick Fury, a colonel in the U.S. Army, who had also been a top CIA operative. Other top SHIELD members include Timothy "Dum-Dum" DUGAN, Valentina Allegro De Fontaine, and Jasper Sitwell.

For many years, SHIELD's headquarters was the Helicarrier, a huge flying aircraft carrier that was kept airborne at all times. It carried a squadron of jet fighters and an ICBM. The Helicarrier was damaged and even destroyed several times over the years, but SHIELD rebuilt it every time and maintained many regional headquarters throughout the world.

SHIELD also kept close ties to the Super Hero community and often called upon CAPTAIN AMERICA, the AVENGERS, and the FANTASTIC FOUR for help. In addition to battling earthly terrorist and military threats, SHIELD saved the world many times from extraterrestrial invasion and infiltration. As well as its human operatives, SHIELD also employed Life Model Decoys (LMDs), incredibly lifelike androids sent into extremely dangerous situations to help avoid human casualties. Nick Fury was known to deploy several LMDs of himself to confuse assassins and even the agents working beneath him.

Over the years, SHIELD's main adversaries included HYDRA, AIM, Zodiac, the Corporation, the YELLOW CLAW, the VIPER, the RED SKULL, CENTURIOUS, and DR. DEMONICUS. SHIELD provided intelligence and technical support to the Avengers and the Fantastic Four during the KREE-SKULL War, when a battle of the aliens took place very close to Earth.

Although chartered by the UN, SHIELD maintained close ties to the US. The UN also founded a number of sister organizations. ARMOR (Altered-Reality Monitoring and Operational Response) stopped invasions from other universes, and SWORD (Sentient World Observation and Response Department) defended the planet from alien invasions.



As director of SHIELD, Maria Hill tried to cut the agency's dependency on Super Heroes and rely on human resources instead.



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Strange Tales #135** Nick Fury, who will be the organization's top operative and eventual leader, is recruited by SHIELD.
- **Strange Tales #158** HYDRA Island sinks, and Baron Wolfgang Von Strucker, HYDRA's leader, is killed.



Iron Man was made director of SHIELD after defeating one of its staunchest allies, Captain America, during the Civil War.

TROUBLE AT THE TOP

While acting as director of SHIELD, Nick Fury gathered a secret team of Super Heroes and launched a covert attempt to topple the government of Latveria, then run by Prime Minister Lucia von Bardas. Although helped by CAPTAIN AMERICA, SPIDER-MAN, LUKE CAGE, DAREDEVIL, BLACK WIDOW, WOLVERINE, and agent Daisy Johnson (now known as Quake), the mission failed. Fury had all memories of the mission wiped from the heroes' minds.

A year later, Latveria launched an attack on New York City in revenge, and Fury's role in the disaster was exposed. He resigned soon afterward and then disappeared underground.

Eager to show a clean break with Fury, the UN appointed relative outsider Maria Hill as the next director of SHIELD. Hill was leading the organization when the Superhuman Registration Act was passed, placing her in charge of controlling all registered superhumans in the US—and of hunting down the rest. She served as director throughout the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), but when the conflict finally resolved, she suggested that Tony Stark—who had led the pro-registration heroes as IRON MAN—take over as director and that she serve as his deputy.



FURY'S SECRET WARRIORS

- 1 Nick Fury
- 2 Phobos
- 3 Druid
- 4 Slingshot
- 5 Stonewall
- 6 Quake
- 7 Hellfire

As director of SHIELD, Stark developed and executed an ambitious agenda. To handle and efficiently utilize the influx of superhumans now working for SHIELD, he started the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9), designed to place a team of Super Heroes in every state. He also ordered a new Helicarrier (later destroyed by the Red Hulk) using the latest Stark technology. He also used SHIELD money to fund the Avengers and their headquarters in Stark Tower.

THE NEW ORDER

After SHIELD failed to predict and prevent the Secret Invasion, Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN) replaced Stark as director. He immediately renamed the organization HAMMER (without bothering to come up with words for the acronym). He also turned the THUNDERBOLTS into his personal black-ops team and created a new version of the Avengers with himself in the lead as the Iron Patriot.

Fury resurfaced during the invasion with his own team of Secret Warriors to help defeat the Skrulls. During this event, he discovered that HYDRA had been secretly controlling SHIELD from its founding, and he rededicated his team to bringing his old foes down. MF



As the Iron Patriot, Norman Osborn led both the official Avengers team and SHIELD's replacement organization, HAMMER.



The terrorist organization HYDRA, dedicated to world domination, is SHIELD's greatest enemy.